

University Engagement Program – Mentorship Program 2026

I. Program Timeline:

Weeks	Milestones
Week 1: June 15 – June 21	Introductory Week: Each team will have been assigned a mentor. You should receive an email thread between you and your mentor. <i>Team Action Item:</i> • Team members should reach-out to their respective mentor and agree on a meeting timing. During this week you should have your first meeting where you share background, get introduced to your mentor and share your preliminary idea. • Ideation and Scoping: Students should work on finalizing their idea. By the end of this week students should be able to answer the following questions: 1- Clearly define the problem your team is solving 2- What is your solution? Is it software as a service or a product? 3- What is the industry or domain under which your solution falls? Examples: Education, Finance, Healthcare, Sustainability, Social Impact, E-commerce, Productivity, Cybersecurity, etc. 4- Who is your target audience? 5- Who are your competitors? 6- What is your added value? Students must share these answers with their mentors and receive feedback. <i>Mentor Action Item:</i> • Agree with your team on a fixed weekly meeting time. Each mentor should meet with their team at least once per week to ensure continuous progress and support. • During the introductory meeting share your background and technical expertise. Provide feedback on team's preliminary idea and answers to the above questions, discuss student goals and project expectations.
Week 2: June 22 – June 28	Design and Planning: <i>Team Action Item:</i> • Design Document: Students will work on preparing a design document to be shared and reviewed by their mentor. The design document should include: - The Problem - High Level Description of the Solution

	- At least 3 core features - Low-level system design - Alternatives considered - Technology stack - A visual prototype (Figma or mermaid diagrams or any other suitable diagrams) reflecting key user flows and design architecture. • Review this document with your mentor during your next meeting. <i>Mentor Action Item:</i> • Review the document and provide actionable feedback. Ensure design choices align with team goals and capabilities.
Week 3: June 29 – July 5	Implementation Phase: <i>Team Action Item:</i> • Start Implementation: Implementation of the project begins this week. All teams should actively start developing their assigned features according to the design document. • Duty Allocation: Convert your design document into actionable tasks. Teams can use JIRA or Trello to model their tasks and organize their work. Make sure to equally divide the tasks among the team members. (<i>Optional:</i> Work in Agile development and sprint planning workstyle) • GitHub Creation: All teams are expected to create a GitHub repository to enable collaboration among team members during the project development. <i>Mentor Action Item:</i> • Duty Allocation: Give students a very brief introduction about agile development and spring planning (Optional). Support students on how to model the tasks and split duties among team members. Ensure everyone knows their specific tasks and responsibilities to facilitate smooth progress.
Week 4: July 6 – July 12	Market Insight and Testing: <i>Team Action Item:</i> • Prepare a survey to be shared with potential users to collect information on what users are looking for in such solutions. Listen to the customer's need. • Conduct basic user testing with at least three individuals.

	<i>Mentor Action Item:</i> Customer Obsession: Encourage students to look into customer's needs. • Encourage students to conduct basic user testing with at least three individuals. • Review survey questions and the quality of feedback collected. • Help them analyze results and discuss potential refinements to the prototype.
Week 5, 6, 7, 8: July 13 – August 9	Project Development: <i>Team Action Item:</i> • Continue Working on Project. Reach-out to mentor for any assistance. <i>Mentor Action Item:</i> • Provide guidance on overcoming technical challenges and refining key features.
Week 9: August 10 – August 16	Integration of Components: <i>Team Action Item:</i> • Integrate Components: This week, teams should focus on integrating the various components of their project to ensure they work seamlessly together. Example: Integrating frontend with backend, connecting databases, APIs, etc... <i>Mentor Action Item:</i> • Provide guidance and support if needed.
Week 9: August 17 – August 23	Mentor Consultation and Task Finalization: Consultation and Finalization: • Meet with your team to review progress and finalize outstanding tasks. • Ensure alignment with initial goals and that all mentor feedback has been incorporated.
Week 10: August 24 – August 31	Final Submissions: <i>Team Action Item:</i> • Submit Final Code: Teams are required to submit the final version of their code. Ensure that all code is well-documented and fully functional. • Submit Final Report: A comprehensive final report must be submitted, detailing the project's development process, challenges encountered, and solutions implemented.

	• Submit Working Demo: Teams must provide a video demonstration of their project. This should be a screen recording showcasing the functionality of your website or application, highlighting key features and user interactions.
TBD	• Final Pitching Ceremony: Each team will have 5 minutes to pitch their project in front of a jury composed of representatives followed by 2-minute Q&A. Teams will be evaluated based on a judging rubric that will be shared with you in advance. The exact time and date of the ceremony will be confirmed later during the program.